

M-08 — Instructions, Context & Role

What is this about?

How much background to give — and the point where adding more starts making the answer worse.

The idea, in plain terms

Nikhil coordinates projects for a Hyderabad office. He asks for "a project plan for a warehouse fit-out". He gets a polished twelve-week plan, with roles the company does not have, for a country it does not operate in. Four lines of context, and the plan describes your project. In Role-Based Prompts: Meera runs quality checks at a Coimbatore plant. She asks for an explanation of a rejection trend to send to the sales team. What comes back is full of process capability indices. Sales read two lines and call her instead.

Key things to know

- WHO IS READING — "a client who is already annoyed with us"
- WHAT WE DO — "we run bonded warehousing in Bhiwandi"
- WHERE — "India, so rupees and Indian labour rules"
- WHY NOW — "they escalated to my director this morning"

A simple example

Situation: A contractor has missed two deadlines. Your director wants a firm email sent today. You have the dates, the contract terms and thirty seconds to think.

What to do: Write four context lines and three instructions, with no names.

Remember

- **Four lines it cannot guess** — Who is reading, what we do, where we are, why it matters now.
- **Context is not instruction** — One describes the situation, the other says what to do with it. Label both.
- **Say what not to do** — No pleasantries, no restating the request, one specific apology.
- **Volume equals emphasis** — Whatever you write most about becomes what the answer is about.
- **The new colleague test** — Would they need this to do the job? If not, leave it out.

Inducto Learning & Knowledge — quick reference for M-08. Watch the lesson video for the full explanation; this page is a takeaway, not a replacement for it.